



5 Position a smaller bowl or other container, also filled with gravel, on top of the built-up section of gravel, to create the planting area for your marginal plants.



6 Add the second, contrasting gravel to your large bowl on the other side of the pebble divide.



7 Plant up the lower-level and marginal plants by simply burying their roots in the gravel.



8 Fill the container with rainwater or distilled water; it will look cloudy at first, but will turn clear as the particles settle. Drop the floating plants into the water and decorate with more pebbles and shells until you are happy with the finished result.

CARE ADVICE

WHERE TO SITE

Place where it will receive 4–6 hours of sunlight a day, but do not put in direct sunlight as this may turn the water green. You can keep it outside in summer but do not leave out in winter or in freezing conditions.



FEEDING AND GENERAL CARE

Use a slow-release aquatic fertilizer capsule placed directly under the plant in early spring or at planting. Liquid fertilizers tend to discolour the water. Do not feed in autumn and winter when plants are dormant. Remove any leaves or other debris, pull off any dead roots from floating water plants, and keep the water levels topped up. Try adding activated carbon granules occasionally, which remove impurities to keep the water clear and sweet smelling.